

Chapter 107-1

When Xu Qingzhu said the two characters "jiejie," her enunciation was always a bit strange.

There was an indescribable tenderness and sweetness to it.

More heart-stirring than any other term of address.

Just like this morning when she called out "jiejie" at home—it made Liang Shi's heart itch.

Even after leaving that situation, just thinking about it would make one subconsciously pinch their earlobe.

Her ears felt hot.

But at this moment, Liang Shi asked: "Why someone from when you were little?"

Xu Qingzhu laughed softly, turning the steering wheel to make a turn. Her cool voice carried nostalgia and longing, full of tenderness: "Because we haven't seen each other for a very long time."

"Then why not go see her?" Liang Shi said. "You like her so much."

When she said the second half, Liang Shi's voice was very soft.

She lowered her eyes, her fingers casually swiping across her phone screen—though the screen was actually black.

Swiping back and forth, there was nothing to look at.

But it was better than looking sideways at Xu Qingzhu.

When mentioning the jiejie she hadn't seen for a long time, Xu Qingzhu's tone was light and slow, and her smile was gentle.

It was a rare expression to see.

When Liang Shi said that half-sentence, her heart still held a faint expectation.

Holding her breath.

But Xu Qingzhu answered lightly: "She doesn't remember me anymore."

Splat.

The heart that had been waiting for Xu Qingzhu's denial fell.

Liang Shi had an indescribable feeling, like sinking into the deep sea—very suffocating.

She pressed the car window button. The chaotic wind blew her hair back and brought a chill to her face, giving her some clarity.

Liang Shi slowly adjusted her breathing, trying to sound as normal as possible, and said gently: "That's really a pity."

The falling tone of "pity" didn't actually sound all that regretful.

The car stopped at a red light. Xu Qingzhu glanced at Liang Shi from the corner of her eye, watching her fingers casually swipe across the dark screen, watching her lower her eyes as if lost in thought.

Xu Qingzhu curled her fingers and tapped on the steering wheel, tapping out a soothing rhythm.

A piano piece was playing on the car stereo.

"Teacher Liang." Xu Qingzhu's tone lifted slightly as she called out to her in a low voice.

Liang Shi responded: "Mm."

"Unhappy?" Xu Qingzhu asked lightly.

Liang Shi instinctively denied it: "Not at all. I'm quite happy."

Xu Qingzhu: "Oh?"

The car started moving again, accelerating to merge into the traffic flow.

After a moment, Liang Shi's voice sounded in the car, carrying an almost imperceptible helplessness as she corrected her earlier answer: "I am a little bit unhappy."

—Only a little bit.

Xu Qingzhu smiled with curved lips. The wind blew in from Liang Shi's side of the car window, passing by Liang Shi before reaching her.

It somehow felt gentler.

The piano piece was gentle and lingering, intertwined with the sound of the wind. Xu Qingzhu's cool voice sounded in the car: "What is there to be unhappy about?"

Liang Shi glanced sideways at her and saw that she was smiling.

The corners of her eyes lifted—a cunning and satisfied smile.

Liang Shi's mood unconsciously relaxed. She retorted: "You wouldn't understand."

Xu Qingzhu nodded, playing along: "Yes, yes, yes. I don't understand."

Liang Shi felt her attitude was perfunctory and scoffed lightly: "I already said it's only a little bit."

"Oh." Xu Qingzhu clicked her tongue. "So I only have a little bit of importance. Got it."

Liang Shi: "....."

"That's not what I meant." Liang Shi wanted to explain, but Xu Qingzhu cut her off: "Then what did you mean?"

Liang Shi: "....."

She was suddenly at a loss for words.

Liang Shi, who had never been good with words in this regard, didn't know what adjectives to use to describe her feelings when her emotions were too complex.

Let alone at this moment.

So after a few seconds of silence, she turned her head to look out the window and slowed her voice: "Whatever you think it is, that's what it is."

Liang Shi said: "I'm not good with words. I can't out-talk you."

Xu Qingzhu: "?"

"Are you angry?" Xu Qingzhu asked.

Liang Shi shook her head: "No."

After saying that, fearing Xu Qingzhu wouldn't believe her, she added: "Really."

Xu Qingzhu couldn't help but smile. The amusement swirled in her eyes, but she didn't show it on her face, which still maintained its cool expression.

But as soon as she spoke, she gave herself away: "If you're angry, there's nothing I can do about it."

Liang Shi: "....."

"Teacher Xu." Liang Shi turned her head again to look at Xu Qingzhu, who was driving with a serious expression.

Cold air swept through the car. Xu Qingzhu's sleeves were rolled up a bit, and the exposed section of her arm had turned slightly red from the cold wind. On her wrist was a diamond-studded watch with a black band, which made her skin look even whiter.

Xu Qingzhu was driving and found her hair flying around annoying, as it affected her vision. So she had tied her long hair into a loose ponytail, leaving some stray hairs on both sides of her face that kept being blown about.

The curve of her profile was also impossibly beautiful.

Facing her, Liang Shi's heart always softened. She had originally wanted to make a jab at her, but by the time the words reached her lips, they had turned into a helpless tone: "Stop teasing me."

Xu Qingzhu feigned surprise: "Huh? Am I?"

"You are." Liang Shi gritted her teeth as she called her name, helplessness mixed with a hint of tenderness: "Xu Qingzhu, I'm already angry."

It should have been an icy cold statement, but spoken in her gentle voice, it carried an alluring ambiguity.

Xu Qingzhu's heart stirred at those words, but she didn't show it on her face.

She let the silence spread through the car.